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Trontek Electronics Pvt Ltd.

S-261, Rajinder Place, New Delhi-110008

Ph.: - 91-11-64500900, 45572222

Mob - 9211605333, 9871280808

Fax: 011- 25481607

E-mail - Sales@trontekindia.com,

Website :- www.trontekindia.com

TAIWAN:

TRONTEK ELECTRONIC TECH CO. LTD.

4F, No. 163, Shing Ming Road, Nei-hu, Taipei

Taiwan, R.O.C. 114

Tel.: 886 2 27936715, 886 2 27942396

Fax: 886 2 27936716

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TRONTEK GROUP

systems for multiple product segments across verticals.

With the constant evolution of embedded technology, the industry is set to witness rapid strides in design and development of more devices for the growing domestic and overseas markets.

Market trends in embedded systems

In the changing computing paradigm, when computing is moving from client-server mode through the Internet through ubiquitous computing, there are some distinct trends impacting the embedded systems industry. These include shift from fixed-function to multi-function devices, analogue to digital media, proprietary to commercial software, 8- and 16-bit to 32-bit and higher processors, limited fixed-line bandwidth to high-bandwidth wired/wireless, and standalone to integration between embedded devices and the Web.

A significant trend is the convergence of functions into a single device, and this is set to expand the potential of embedded systems. This trend in network security toward converging many discrete functions into one device, is referred to as the integrated services router (ISR) and also known as universal threat management or secure services gateway. The ISR is rapidly becoming the single-most important network security device in many enterprises, particularly in small- and mid-size offices. A number of additional developments include better connectivity, bandwidth availability and higher processing power.

What is also tremendously adding more leverage to embedded systems today is the fact that they can talk with each other through wireless connectivity. In fact, the need for wireless connectivity in embedded systems is increasing phenomenally with consumers, employees and enterprises alike becoming accustomed to having continual access to information resources anytime, anywhere. This has resulted in information appliances such as

mobile handsets, PDAs and notebooks adding capabilities for voice and data transmission. This connectivity allows more traditional embedded systems to report information to a central clearinghouse and obtain information from outside sources. Systems such as point-of-sale terminals and surveillance cameras also become easier to implement, when they offer wireless connectivity.

India, the last frontier

Many still believe that India will be the last frontier for semiconductor manufacturing and attract some of the industry powerhouses. To facilitate this, there already exist a number of ongoing semiconductor industry developments involving local companies and Indian investors. From the Indian and internationally-acclaimed IT hub, Bengaluru, to the southern city of Hyderabad, where the Fab City project was announced a few years ago, to the emerging townships of Noida, we are seeing more interest in the Indian market.

However, at this gateway of the exploding market potential, the demand for high-level, intense and unbiased education is at a critical point for Indian design engineers. If embedded systems are to become a serious discipline that contributes to the progression of the Indian economy and global demand in general, it is quite natural that the country's proven expertise in IT software will play a monumental role in developing talent with the required skills. To create and nurture this ecosystem, India will also need to strengthen its partnerships with world leaders in this domain and aggressively drive the momentum to achieve optimal-quality and, at the same time, cost-effective technologies. ●

The author is the country manager-India, Wind River. Based in Bengaluru, the company's India headquarters, he is responsible for growing the region's revenues, attracting and retaining the best of human talent, maintaining leadership position in the device software optimisation marketplace and spreading the awareness of Wind River technologies in education and Universities.